

*Example 9:* [...] But affirmative action is still desperately needed in America's best universities to combat the racial divisions that colorblindness does nothing to resolve. Here's why. [...]

While we have made significant progress on addressing America's racist past, we still have much to do regarding the racism that our society continues to tacitly allow.

It should come as no surprise that whites continue to have a higher median income than black and Hispanic Americans (we'll get into why Asian Americans have a higher median income than even whites, as well as their role in the affirmative action debate, later). The average black American earns close to 41 percent less income than the average white, while the typical Hispanic earns 27 percent less income than their white counterparts.

Noting these statistics, some have proposed income-based affirmative action as an effective alternative to race-based affirmative action, presuming that the problems plaguing America's minority communities are caused by class, not race. But while income inequality does exacerbate racial divisions in America, it cannot fully account for those divisions. Even controlled for income, racial minorities face challenges their white peers don't have to deal with. (Gordon and Wang 2019)

